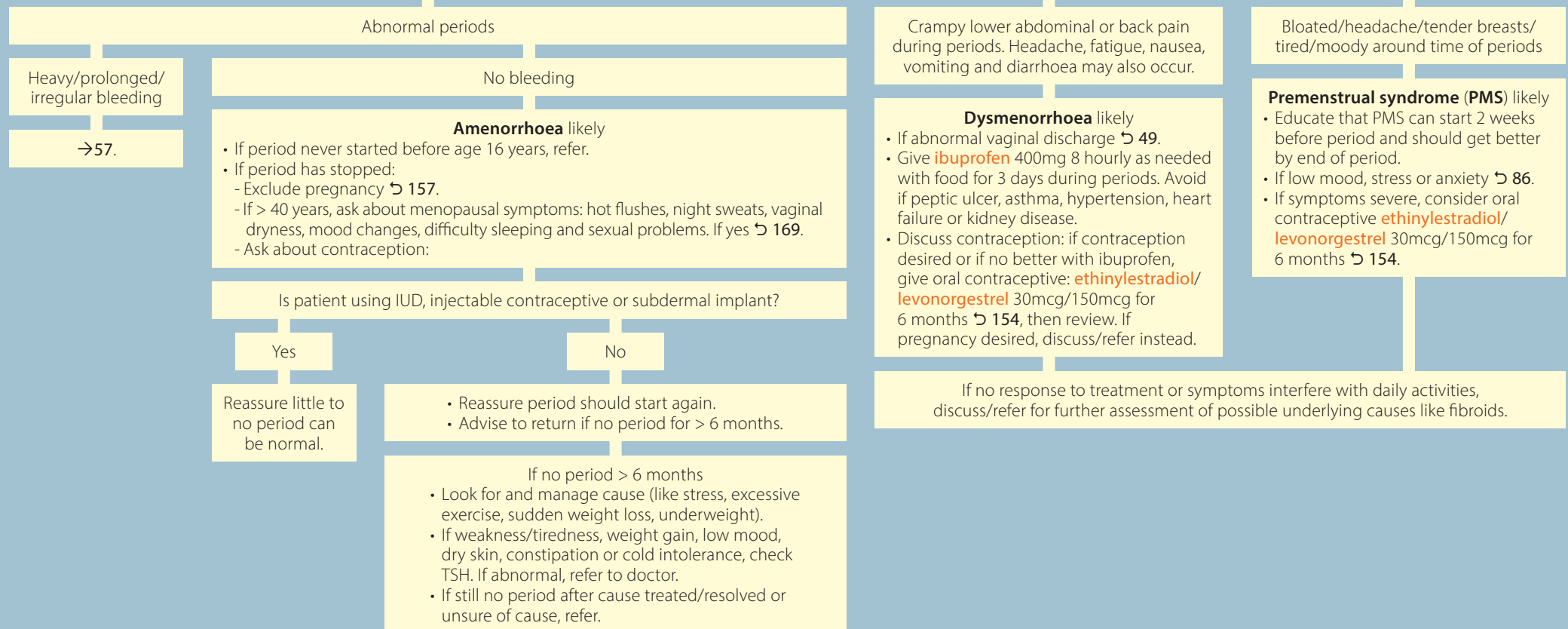


MENSTRUAL SYMPTOMS

Approach to the patient with menstrual symptoms

Manage according to symptom: ask if abnormal periods, crampy pain during periods or bloating/headache/tender breasts/tired/moody around time of periods.



Advise the patient with menstrual symptoms

- Explain that menstruation (having a period) is normal and healthy, and educate what menstruation is: every month the uterus lining thickens to prepare for pregnancy. When pregnancy does not happen, the thickened lining is released through the vagina, as bleeding for a few days.
- Reassure that dysmenorrhoea (abdominal/back pain with periods) is common. Encourage to continue with daily activities and exercise.
- If premenstrual syndrome: advise to do daily exercise and try relaxation techniques ↗ 86.